

Gauntlet v0.6.3 Reference Guide

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Setup

Faction setup → Draw 4 / discard 1 / keep 3 → arrange Territories → form and reveal Gauntlet → place tokens → roll first player

- Shuffle the remaining Deck to form the Draw Pile after faction setup.
- Arrange Territories with the opening Hand and face-up opening discard known.
- Each token starts on the Territory at its player's own end; setup placement is neither movement nor entering.
- Roll for first player only after both players complete opening selection and Territory arrangement.

Run the Gauntlet

Win immediately by either:

- capturing the Territory at your opponent's end; or
- winning your opponent's Last Stand.

After forcing the opponent beyond their end, a **separate legal movement sequence** may Advance beyond the Gauntlet and initiate the Last Stand. You do not need to control the final Territory first.

Your Turn

Capture → Draw → Opening → Movement → Denouement → Cleanup

Capture

If your token is beyond your **Front Line**, capture the next opposing Territory immediately beyond that line.

- Your controlled Territories must remain contiguous from your own end.
- Your position may extend beyond your control.
- Normal Capture advances your Front Line by at most one Territory per turn.

Draw

Draw one card.

Opening

You may take your Action now.

Movement

Choose one:

- **Advance:** move one position toward the opponent's end.
- **Hold:** remain where you are.
- **Fall Back:** move one position toward your own end.

Entering the opponent's position creates a pending battle and ends the current movement sequence.

Denouement

You may take your Action now if you did not take it during Opening.

Cleanup

Resolve end-of-turn effects and discard down to the Hand limit. Pass the active-player marker.

Card use reminder

Cards may print **Action**, **Asset**, **Gambit**, **Tactic**, or **Gambit/Tactic** effects. A card with an Asset effect has an inherent Bank Action unless it prints a special banking procedure.

Actions

Each turn, normally take **one Action** during either Opening or Denouement.

An Action may:

- play one card for its **Action** effect;
- bank one card from Hand using its inherent **Bank** Action if it has an Asset effect;
- take one legal **Faction Action**; or
- discard one of your Assets.

Normally take no more than one Action during either phase.

An additional Action does not by itself permit two Actions during the same phase.

A **Faction Action** lists the phase in which it is legal.

A **Faction Ability** occurs at its stated timing and does not use an Action unless it says otherwise.

Pending Battle and Terms

Pending battle → Terms → Onset → Gambits

Before Onset:

1. establish the attacker, defender, contested position, and the attacker's previous position;
2. resolve the Terms timing if a Diplomat is involved; and
3. proceed according to the decision.

Accepted Terms

Apply the Proposal's Accepted effect. No battle begins.

Unless the Proposal says otherwise:

The attacker withdraws. The defender remains at the contested position.

No Onset, Gambit, Reserve, Tactic, Outcome, or Aftermath occurs.

Refused or no Terms

Proceed to **Onset**.

Battle

Onset → set Gambits → form Reserves → reveal Gambits → choose Tactics → reveal Tactics → Outcome → Aftermath

Onset

Onset begins the battle. Resolve Onset effects before Gambits are set.

Outcome

The higher battle total wins.

Defensive Edge

Defensive Edge: When the defender has Defensive Edge, the defender wins tied battle totals.

The defender normally has Defensive Edge when:

- the defender controls the contested Territory; or
- the defender is making a Last Stand.

An effect may remove Defensive Edge, including an applicable Arena Territory effect.

Tiebreak Roll

If the tie remains unresolved:

Each player rolls one die. Do not apply advantage, disadvantage, card effects, numerical modifiers, or the previous battle totals. Higher roll wins. Reroll further ties.

Only an effect that expressly refers to a **Tiebreak Roll** may modify it.

Retreat and Withdrawal

A losing player retreats; a player who leaves without losing withdraws.

Retreat and withdrawal normally move a player the same way:

- attacker: return to the position from which they entered;
- defender: move one position toward their own end;
- only the attacker withdraws: the defender remains in the contested position;
- only the defender withdraws: the attacker remains in the contested position and becomes the occupier when applicable;

- both withdraw: move the attacker first, then the defender; neither becomes the occupier because of the withdrawal.

Retreat

- follows a battle loss;
- the battle has a winner and loser;
- win, loss, retreat, Occupation, and other result effects apply.

Withdrawal

- ends or prevents a pending or active battle without a winner;
- win, loss, and retreat effects do not occur;
- before Onset: no battle or Aftermath occurs;
- after Onset: complete the remaining non-result steps of the Aftermath and clear any committed battle cards using their normal destinations.

Fall Back is ordinary Movement. It is neither retreat nor withdrawal.

Front Line

Your **Front Line** is the unbroken sequence of Territories you control from your own end.

- Control cannot skip an opposing Territory.
- Your token may move beyond your Front Line.
- During Capture, add the next opposing Territory immediately beyond your Front Line if your token is on or beyond it.
- The captured Territory may be behind your token.
- Deep Position alone does not capture the final Territory. Last Stand access instead requires a new legal Advance beyond the opponent's end after that opponent is beyond the Gauntlet.

Core Vocabulary

Term	Meaning
Opening	Action phase before Movement.
Denouement	Action phase after Movement and any resulting battle.
Faction Action	Faction-specific option chosen when taking an Action; lists its legal phase.
Faction Ability	Faction-specific effect at its own timing; does not use an Action unless stated.
Fall Back	Ordinary Movement one position toward your own end.
Pending battle	Pre-battle state before Onset.
Onset	Opening stage of an active battle.
Aftermath	Closing stage of an active battle.
Defensive Edge	Conditional benefit that causes the defender to win tied battle totals.
Tiebreak Roll	Separate unmodified one-die sudden-death roll.
Front Line	Contiguous controlled Territories from your own end.
Retreat	Displacement after losing a battle.
Withdraw	Leave or prevent a battle without determining a winner.

